

Topic: **History and Importance of Hadith.**

Sub Topics: **Stages of Compilation of Hadith.**

(a) Trace the main stages from the lifetime of Holy Prophet (PBUH) till the compilation of six authoritative books. [10]

Structure of Answer
▪ Para 1 = Compilation during the lifetime of Holy Prophet (PBUH).
▪ Para 2 = Compilation during the age of companions (11 A.H till 100 A.H)
▪ Para 3 = Compilation during the age of Successors of Companions (100 A.H till 200 A.H)
▪ Para 4 = Compilation during the age of Successors of Companions (200 A.H till 300 A.H)

Points to be Covered
▪ Quran declares Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) the best role model and excellent pattern for humanity: 📖 Ref: "There has certainly been for you in the Messenger of Allah an excellent pattern for anyone whose hope is in Allah and the Last Day and [who] remembers Allah often." [33:21] ▪ Sayings, actions and silent approvals of Prophet (PBUH) were meant to be compiled so this compilation can be the ultimate guide for humanity till the day of judgement. ▪ At first, Prophet (PBUH) stopped companions from writing Hadiths so it does not get mixed with revelation of Quran. He drew their attention towards memorization and verbal teaching. Only treaties and letters can be found as written record of early and mid-years of Islam. ▪ Companions who went an extra mile to memorize and narrate Hadiths were Ayesha (RA), Anas bin Malik (RA), Abdullah bin Abbas (RA), Abdullah bin Umar (RA), Jabir bin Abdullah (RA), Abu Hurairah (RA) and other members of Suffah (first school of Islam). ▪ When revelation and writing of Quran reached near completion, he allowed his companions to make written compilations of Hadith. ▪ Some of the written compilations include Kitab-us-Sadaqah about the rules of Zakat, was written on Prophet's (PBUH) orders, Booklet of Amr bin Hazm containing rules of Prayer, Zakat, purification and administrative laws, Saheefa-e-Sadiqah written by Abdullah bin Amr (RA) and Booklet of Anas bin Malik. Some of them were even checked and endorsed by Prophet (PBUH).
▪ Soon after the demise of Holy Prophet (PBUH) companions put their maximum efforts to spread the teachings of Quran and Sunnah and travelled across the Arab and even beyond. They set up different centers of learning and teachings of Hadith. Some of them were Makkah, Madinah, Koofa, Busra, Damascus etc. ▪ Wives of Holy Prophet (PBUH) and other female companions also took part in these efforts to spread the message of Allah and Prophet (PBUH) everywhere. Ayesha (RA) set up a school at her place and loads of students would come and learn Hadiths of Prophet (PBUH) from her. A lot of compilers of Hadith were students of Ayesha's (RA) students. ▪ The famous written compilation of this era include Booklets of Abdullah bin Abbas (RA), Ubadah bin

Samit (RA), Samrah bin Jundub (RA), Jabir bin Abdullah (RA) and Booklet of Abu Hurairah (RA).
▪ So far the work of compilation of Hadith was done on individual basis. Umar bin Abdul Aziz (RA) a great Umayyad ruler wrote a letter to governor of Madinah and asked him to gather scholars of Madinah and make compilations of Hadiths. Imam Zuhri (RA) was the biggest scholar of Madinah who along with help of other narrators, compiled tons of books and sent them to Damascus where they were copied and distributed in Islamic world. ▪ Other compilers were Hasan Basri, Urwah bin Zubair, Imam Abu Hanifa, Imam Malik, Sufyan Thauri, Sufyan bin Uyainah and Ahmed bin Hanbal. All these scholars made written compilations of Hadith and played major role in the mission of preservation of Hadith.
▪ This age is considered the golden age of compilation of Hadith as successors of successors took this matter very seriously. They did not only make some excellent compilations but paid special attention about differentiating between strong, weak and fabricated Hadiths. The six authoritative books of Hadith (Sihah-e-Sittah) were also compiled in this era. The first book among six authoritative books and most authentic book after the Holy Quran is Saheeh Bukhari written by Muhammad bin Ismail Bukhari which contains 7257 Hadiths. Saheeh Muslim is written by Muslim bin Al-Hajaj that contains 9200 Hadiths. Sunan Abu Dawud written by Imam Abu Dawud contains 4800 traditions. Jami' Tirmizi written by Imam Tirmizi contains 4400 Hadiths. Sunan Nasai written by Abu Abdulrahman Al Nasai contains 5700 Hadiths and last one is Sunan Ibn-e-Majah that contains 4341 Hadiths. ▪ This was the finest work could possibly be done by any community to preserve the life and sayings of their Prophet. Finally, Muslims were able to preserve the sayings, actions and silent approvals of Holy Prophet (PBUH) so they can get guidance from it till the day of judgement.

Q (b) What was the significance of Prophet (PBUH) not allowing the written compilation of Hadith in early days of his Prophethood?

Points to be Covered
▪ Prophet (PBUH) wanted to establish Islam and make sure his sayings were not mixed up with the words of the Qur'an which was still being revealed. ▪ Prophet (PBUH) motivated them to focus on verbal teaching and memorization. ▪ As soon as the revelation of Quran reached near completion and Prophet (PBUH) was certain that his companions would be able to distinguish between the Hadiths and the words of the Qur'an he encouraged them to write down the Hadiths to pass them down to others.

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